

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Liberty, Equality and Property - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Liberty, Equality and Property

TEN-SESSION CORE PATH • PRACTICE • OPTIONAL ADVANCED • REGISTER NOTES

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|--|--|
| 1 The Triad, Liberty versus Licence and Three Spheres of Freedom | 2 Mill, Green, Berlin and Competing Positive-Liberty Languages |
| 3 Equality, Opportunity, Outcome, Rawls, Dworkin and Mill | 4 Property as Security and Power: Locke, Hegel and Marx |
| 5 Berlin, MacCallum and Taylor as Named Liberty Evidence | 6 Functionless Property and Nozick's Entitlement Theory |
| 7 Synthesis, Indian Applications and Objection-Reply Chains | 8 Republican Non-Domination: Mechanism and Benevolent Master |
| 9 Republican Law, Objections and Three-Family Comparison | 10 Answer Architecture, Evidence Units and Final Recall |

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Liberty, Equality and Property - Solved Practice Workbook

Generation: learner-v2:g2 **PYQ ownership:** Every verified question below retains the primary owner recorded in the source ledger.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

MCQ 1

A person's claimed freedom would subject others to coercive dependence. Which statement explains why liberty must be distinguished from licence?

- A. Liberty rejects unreasonable restraint, whereas licence lets one person's action become another's oppression.
- B. Mill places the burden of proof on coercion and permits it presumptively to prevent harm to others, not mere offence or paternal benefit.
- C. Taylor argues that an open opportunity is insufficient where internalised or social obstacles prevent meaningful exercise, while Berlin warns against paternalist correction.
- D. Formal equality removes explicit exclusion, while substantive equality tests usable access, background conditions and actual opportunity.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Liberty versus licence** with **Liberty rejects unreasonable restraint, whereas licence lets one person's action become another's oppression**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 2

A factory owner claims an unlimited freedom to impose conditions that leave workers without meaningful choice. Which distinction shows why one person's freedom cannot become another's oppression?

- A. Alterability plus rational differentiation
- B. Liberty versus licence
- C. Hobhouse-Tawney-Laski functionless property
- D. Hayek-Friedman market-liberty cluster

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Liberty rejects unreasonable restraint, whereas licence lets one person's action become another's oppression**. with **Liberty versus licence**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 3

A society protects worship and elections while leaving workers without material independence. Which statement identifies the three spheres needed for diagnosis?

- A. Roosevelt's January 1941 Four Freedoms address and the August 1941 Atlantic Charter are related but distinct documents.
- B. Domination exists where another has capacity for arbitrary interference with impunity, even when that capacity is not exercised.
- C. Civil liberty protects personal action, political liberty enables participation, and economic liberty concerns material independence and bargaining power.
- D. Alterability makes inequality a practical reform target but does not by itself prove injustice; need and relevant function still require judgment.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Civil-political-economic liberty** with **Civil liberty protects personal action, political liberty enables participation, and economic liberty concerns material independence and bargaining power**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 4

A citizen may worship freely and vote, yet unemployment leaves her materially dependent on an employer. Which classification reveals the missing sphere of freedom?

- A. Affirmative action and its objections
- B. Nozick acquisition-transfer-rectification
- C. Green-style enabling positive freedom
- D. Civil-political-economic liberty

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Civil liberty protects personal action, political liberty enables participation, and economic liberty concerns material independence and bargaining power** with **Civil-political-economic liberty**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 5

An authority directly obstructs peaceful speech and movement. Which statement gives the relevant liberty test?

- A. Negative liberty asks whether another person or institution obstructs a specified sphere of choice.
- B. Hayek stresses non-coercion and general rules, while Friedman links competitive capitalism to freedom; neither position is identical to Nozick's entitlement theory.
- C. A person under a standing master's power is not free simpliciter; general, reviewable and contestable law can reduce domination.
- D. Affirmative action may rest on compensation, anti-subordination, representation or fair opportunity; reverse discrimination is an objection, not a neutral label.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Negative liberty/non-interference** with **Negative liberty asks whether another person or institution obstructs a specified sphere of choice**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 6

A law blocks an adult from publishing a harmless dissenting opinion. Which liberty family most directly identifies the obstruction?

- A. Property as security versus social power
- B. Negative liberty/non-interference
- C. Marx-Engels alienation and social production
- D. MacCallum's X-free-from-Y-to-do-Z formula

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Negative liberty asks whether another person or institution obstructs a specified sphere of choice.** with **Negative liberty/non-interference.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 7

Poverty and lack of education block meaningful choice even without a legal prohibition. Which statement gives the enabling-freedom response without prescribing a true life plan?

- A. Marcuse analyses false needs and one-dimensional consciousness, while Macpherson contrasts developmental power with extractive power.
- B. Equality affirms equal moral standing without claiming identical talent, need, circumstance or life plan.
- C. Enabling freedom removes socially alterable barriers such as poverty, insecurity and lack of education without dictating a person's true purpose.
- D. Property can support personal independence but concentrated productive ownership can control others' labour and life-chances.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Green-style enabling positive freedom** with **Enabling freedom removes socially alterable barriers such as poverty, insecurity and lack of education without dictating a person's true purpose.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 8

A state funds schooling and health access while leaving citizens free to choose their own life plans. Which conception treats these supports as conditions of agency?

- A. Locke's labour title, money and inequality
- B. Liberty versus licence
- C. Mill's self-/other-regarding boundary
- D. Green-style enabling positive freedom

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Enabling freedom removes socially alterable barriers such as poverty, insecurity and lack of education without dictating a person's true purpose.** with **Green-style enabling positive freedom.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 9

A ruler claims coercion expresses the citizen's rational higher self. Which statement accurately states Berlin's positive pole and its danger?

- A. Berlin's positive pole concerns self-mastery and warns that rulers may coercively claim to represent a person's higher or real self.
- B. MacCallum represents every freedom claim through an agent, a constraint and a purpose without settling which constraints or purposes are justified.
- C. Rousseau separates physical differences from inequalities of wealth, honour, power and dependence created by convention.
- D. Locke joins labour to enough-and-as-good and spoilage provisos; money bypasses spoilage and enables accumulation whose remaining limit is contested.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Berlinian self-mastery and authoritarian risk** with **Berlin's positive pole concerns self-mastery and warns that rulers may coercively claim to represent a person's higher or real self**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 10

A party suppresses dissent while claiming to express citizens' higher rational will. Which conception and warning expose the move?

- A. Personal property versus means of production
- B. Berlinian self-mastery and authoritarian risk
- C. Civil-political-economic liberty
- D. Four Freedoms versus Atlantic Charter

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Berlin's positive pole concerns self-mastery and warns that rulers may coercively claim to represent a person's higher or real self** with **Berlinian self-mastery and authoritarian risk**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 11

Conduct has social effects but causes neither injury nor rights-violation to others. Which statement preserves Mill's burden of proof against coercion?

- A. Formal equality removes explicit exclusion, while substantive equality tests usable access, background conditions and actual opportunity.
- B. Personal holdings support use and security, while private control of major productive assets structures class power.
- C. Mill places the burden of proof on coercion and permits it presumptively to prevent harm to others, not mere offence or paternal benefit.
- D. Civil liberty protects personal action, political liberty enables participation, and economic liberty concerns material independence and bargaining power.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Mill's self-/other-regarding boundary** with **Mill places the burden of proof on coercion and permits it presumptively to prevent harm to others, not mere offence or paternal benefit**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 12

A majority dislikes a competent adult's harmless way of life but cannot identify injury to another person. Which doctrine places the burden against coercion?

- A. Hobhouse-Tawney-Laski functionless property
- B. Negative liberty/non-interference
- C. Hayek-Friedman market-liberty cluster
- D. Mill's self-/other-regarding boundary

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Mill places the burden of proof on coercion and permits it presumptively to prevent harm to others, not mere offence or paternal benefit.** with **Mill's self-/other-regarding boundary.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 13

An answer merges two events from January and August 1941. Which statement repairs the historical attribution?

- A. Roosevelt's January 1941 Four Freedoms address and the August 1941 Atlantic Charter are related but distinct documents.
- B. Domination exists where another has capacity for arbitrary interference with impunity, even when that capacity is not exercised.
- C. Alterability makes inequality a practical reform target but does not by itself prove injustice; need and relevant function still require judgment.
- D. Social-democratic property is judged by service, social origin and common welfare rather than title or dividend alone.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Four Freedoms versus Atlantic Charter** with **Roosevelt's January 1941 Four Freedoms address and the August 1941 Atlantic Charter are related but distinct documents.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 14

A student attributes freedom of speech, worship, want and fear to an August 1941 joint declaration. Which distinction corrects the chronology?

- A. Nozick acquisition-transfer-rectification
- B. Four Freedoms versus Atlantic Charter
- C. Green-style enabling positive freedom
- D. Marcuse versus Macpherson

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Roosevelt's January 1941 Four Freedoms address and the August 1941 Atlantic Charter are related but distinct documents.** with **Four Freedoms versus Atlantic Charter.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 15

A market order is defended through general non-coercive rules and competitive exchange. Which statement distinguishes the two thinkers from Nozick?

- A. A person under a standing master's power is not free simpliciter; general, reviewable and contestable law can reduce domination.
- B. Affirmative action may rest on compensation, anti-subordination, representation or fair opportunity; reverse discrimination is an objection, not a neutral label.
- C. Hayek stresses non-coercion and general rules, while Friedman links competitive capitalism to freedom; neither position is identical to Nozick's entitlement theory.
- D. Enabling freedom removes socially alterable barriers such as poverty, insecurity and lack of education without dictating a person's true purpose.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Hayek-Friedman market-liberty cluster** with **Hayek stresses non-coercion and general rules, while Friedman links competitive capitalism to freedom; neither position is identical to Nozick's entitlement theory**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 16

A policy defence combines general non-coercive rules with competitive capitalism but does not trace historical acquisition. Which cluster is being used?

- A. Marx-Engels alienation and social production
- B. Berlinian self-mastery and authoritarian risk
- C. MacCallum's X-free-from-Y-to-do-Z formula
- D. Hayek-Friedman market-liberty cluster

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Hayek stresses non-coercion and general rules, while Friedman links competitive capitalism to freedom; neither position is identical to Nozick's entitlement theory** with **Hayek-Friedman market-liberty cluster**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 17

A learner confuses false-needs critique with developmental-power analysis. Which statement restores the distinction?

- A. Marcuse analyses false needs and one-dimensional consciousness, while Macpherson contrasts developmental power with extractive power.
- B. Equality affirms equal moral standing without claiming identical talent, need, circumstance or life plan.
- C. Property can support personal independence but concentrated productive ownership can control others' labour and life-chances.
- D. Berlin's positive pole concerns self-mastery and warns that rulers may coercively claim to represent a person's higher or real self.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Marcuse versus Macpherson** with **Marcuse analyses false needs and one-dimensional consciousness, while Macpherson contrasts developmental power with extractive power**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 18

One critic says consumption manufactures compliant desires; another asks whether people possess developmental rather than extractive power. Which contrast applies?

- A. Liberty versus licence
- B. Marcuse versus Macpherson
- C. Mill's self-/other-regarding boundary
- D. Taylor's exercise versus opportunity concept

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Marcuse analyses false needs and one-dimensional consciousness, while Macpherson contrasts developmental power with extractive power**. with **Marcuse versus Macpherson**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 19

Two theories use different constraints and purposes but share one formal freedom grammar. Which statement gives that grammar and its limit?

- A. Rousseau separates physical differences from inequalities of wealth, honour, power and dependence created by convention.
- B. Locke joins labour to enough-and-as-good and spoilage provisos; money bypasses spoilage and enables accumulation whose remaining limit is contested.
- C. MacCallum represents every freedom claim through an agent, a constraint and a purpose without settling which constraints or purposes are justified.
- D. Liberty rejects unreasonable restraint, whereas licence lets one person's action become another's oppression.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **MacCallum's X-free-from-Y-to-do-Z formula** with **MacCallum represents every freedom claim through an agent, a constraint and a purpose without settling which constraints or purposes are justified**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 20

A dispute cannot be resolved until the agent, blocking condition and intended action are each specified. Which formula supplies that structure?

- A. Civil-political-economic liberty
- B. Four Freedoms versus Atlantic Charter
- C. Alterability plus rational differentiation
- D. MacCallum's X-free-from-Y-to-do-Z formula

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **MacCallum represents every freedom claim through an agent, a constraint and a purpose without settling which constraints or purposes are justified.** with **MacCallum's X-free-from-Y-to-do-Z formula.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 21

Formal non-obstruction exists, yet socially formed fear blocks pursuit of a significant aim. Which statement captures Taylor's objection and its Berlinian limit?

- A. Taylor argues that an open opportunity is insufficient where internalised or social obstacles prevent meaningful exercise, while Berlin warns against paternalist correction.
- B. Personal holdings support use and security, while private control of major productive assets structures class power.
- C. Civil liberty protects personal action, political liberty enables participation, and economic liberty concerns material independence and bargaining power.
- D. Roosevelt's January 1941 Four Freedoms address and the August 1941 Atlantic Charter are related but distinct documents.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Taylor's exercise versus opportunity concept** with **Taylor argues that an open opportunity is insufficient where internalised or social obstacles prevent meaningful exercise, while Berlin warns against paternalist correction.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 22

A door is formally open, but internalised fear and social conditioning prevent a person from pursuing a significant purpose. Which distinction diagnoses the gap?

- A. Negative liberty/non-interference
- B. Taylor's exercise versus opportunity concept
- C. Hayek-Friedman market-liberty cluster
- D. Benevolent master and non-arbitrary law

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Taylor argues that an open opportunity is insufficient where internalised or social obstacles prevent meaningful exercise, while Berlin warns against paternalist correction.** with **Taylor's exercise versus opportunity concept.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 23

A superior has unchecked capacity to interfere but chooses not to exercise it today. Which statement identifies the status-based unfreedom?

- A. Alterability makes inequality a practical reform target but does not by itself prove injustice; need and relevant function still require judgment.
- B. Social-democratic property is judged by service, social origin and common welfare rather than title or dividend alone.
- C. Domination exists where another has capacity for arbitrary interference with impunity, even when that capacity is not exercised.
- D. Hayek stresses non-coercion and general rules, while Friedman links competitive capitalism to freedom; neither position is identical to Nozick's entitlement theory.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Republican capacity-arbitrariness-impunity test** with **Domination exists where another has capacity for arbitrary interference with impunity, even when that capacity is not exercised**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 24

An official rarely interferes, yet retains unchecked power to cancel a benefit without reasons or appeal. Which test identifies domination?

- A. Green-style enabling positive freedom
- B. Marcuse versus Macpherson
- C. Equal worth versus sameness
- D. Republican capacity-arbitrariness-impunity test

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Domination exists where another has capacity for arbitrary interference with impunity, even when that capacity is not exercised** with **Republican capacity-arbitrariness-impunity test**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 25

A person faces a standing credible threat under private discretion, while public power is reviewable. Which statement explains why non-interference alone is insufficient?

- A. A person under a standing master's power is not free simpliciter; general, reviewable and contestable law can reduce domination.
- B. Affirmative action may rest on compensation, anti-subordination, representation or fair opportunity; reverse discrimination is an objection, not a neutral label.
- C. Nozick's historical entitlement theory requires a proviso and rectification but leaves the correction of unjust history under-specified.
- D. Enabling freedom removes socially alterable barriers such as poverty, insecurity and lack of education without dictating a person's true purpose.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Benevolent master and non-arbitrary law** with **A person under a standing master's power is not free simpliciter; general, reviewable and contestable law can reduce domination**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 26

A dependent person is usually left alone but lives under another's standing discretion, while a regulated citizen can contest official decisions. Which illustration explains the contrast?

- A. Berlinian self-mastery and authoritarian risk
- B. Benevolent master and non-arbitrary law
- C. MacCallum's X-free-from-Y-to-do-Z formula
- D. Rousseau's natural/conventional inequality

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **A person under a standing master's power is not free simpliciter; general, reviewable and contestable law can reduce domination.** with **Benevolent master and non-arbitrary law.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 27

Citizens differ in talent and circumstance but reject inherited civic rank. Which statement identifies the equality claim?

- A. Property can support personal independence but concentrated productive ownership can control others' labour and life-chances.
- B. Marx and Engels link private control of production to alienation and class domination and seek genuinely social control rather than abolition of personal use.
- C. Equality affirms equal moral standing without claiming identical talent, need, circumstance or life plan.
- D. Berlin's positive pole concerns self-mastery and warns that rulers may coercively claim to represent a person's higher or real self.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Equal worth versus sameness** with **Equality affirms equal moral standing without claiming identical talent, need, circumstance or life plan.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 28

Two citizens have different talents and needs but claim the same civic standing. Which distinction permits both propositions?

- A. Mill's self-/other-regarding boundary
- B. Taylor's exercise versus opportunity concept
- C. Personal property versus means of production
- D. Equal worth versus sameness

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Equality affirms equal moral standing without claiming identical talent, need, circumstance or life plan.** with **Equal worth versus sameness.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 29

Physical variation becomes a hierarchy of honour, property and dependence through institutions. Which statement supplies Rousseau's distinction?

- A. Rousseau separates physical differences from inequalities of wealth, honour, power and dependence created by convention.
- B. Locke joins labour to enough-and-as-good and spoilage provisos; money bypasses spoilage and enables accumulation whose remaining limit is contested.
- C. Liberty rejects unreasonable restraint, whereas licence lets one person's action become another's oppression.
- D. Mill places the burden of proof on coercion and permits it presumptively to prevent harm to others, not mere offence or paternal benefit.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Rousseau's natural/conventional inequality** with **Rousseau separates physical differences from inequalities of wealth, honour, power and dependence created by convention**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 30

Age and strength differ naturally, while rank, wealth and dependence are institutionally created. Which distinction organises the contrast?

- A. Four Freedoms versus Atlantic Charter
- B. Rousseau's natural/conventional inequality
- C. Republican capacity-arbitrariness-impunity test
- D. Hobhouse-Tawney-Laski functionless property

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Rousseau separates physical differences from inequalities of wealth, honour, power and dependence created by convention** with **Rousseau's natural/conventional inequality**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 31

A common legal rule operates over radically unequal starting conditions. Which statement explains why paper access may not be enough?

- A. Personal holdings support use and security, while private control of major productive assets structures class power.
- B. Civil liberty protects personal action, political liberty enables participation, and economic liberty concerns material independence and bargaining power.
- C. Formal equality removes explicit exclusion, while substantive equality tests usable access, background conditions and actual opportunity.
- D. Roosevelt's January 1941 Four Freedoms address and the August 1941 Atlantic Charter are related but distinct documents.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Formal versus substantive equality** with **Formal equality removes explicit exclusion, while substantive equality tests usable access, background conditions and actual opportunity**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 32

An examination is legally open to all, but inherited poverty makes preparation inaccessible to most. Which distinction identifies why identical rules are insufficient?

- A. Hayek-Friedman market-liberty cluster
- B. Benevolent master and non-arbitrary law
- C. Nozick acquisition-transfer-rectification
- D. Formal versus substantive equality

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Formal equality removes explicit exclusion, while substantive equality tests usable access, background conditions and actual opportunity.** with **Formal versus substantive equality.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 33

A difference is socially changeable, but its relevance to a legitimate function remains disputed. Which statement gives the complete test?

- A. Alterability makes inequality a practical reform target but does not by itself prove injustice; need and relevant function still require judgment.
- B. Social-democratic property is judged by service, social origin and common welfare rather than title or dividend alone.
- C. Negative liberty asks whether another person or institution obstructs a specified sphere of choice.
- D. Hayek stresses non-coercion and general rules, while Friedman links competitive capitalism to freedom; neither position is identical to Nozick's entitlement theory.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Alterability plus rational differentiation** with **Alterability makes inequality a practical reform target but does not by itself prove injustice; need and relevant function still require judgment.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 34

A physical difference can be changed by policy, but the proposed classification may still serve a relevant need. Which test prevents alterability alone from proving injustice?

- A. Marcuse versus Macpherson
- B. Alterability plus rational differentiation
- C. Equal worth versus sameness
- D. Property as security versus social power

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Alterability makes inequality a practical reform target but does not by itself prove injustice; need and relevant function still require judgment.** with **Alterability plus rational differentiation.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 35

A programme addresses exclusion, voice and fair access while opponents allege reverse discrimination. Which statement preserves the competing rationales and the status of the objection?

- A. Nozick's historical entitlement theory requires a proviso and rectification but leaves the correction of unjust history under-specified.
- B. Enabling freedom removes socially alterable barriers such as poverty, insecurity and lack of education without dictating a person's true purpose.
- C. Affirmative action may rest on compensation, anti-subordination, representation or fair opportunity; reverse discrimination is an objection, not a neutral label.
- D. Marcuse analyses false needs and one-dimensional consciousness, while Macpherson contrasts developmental power with extractive power.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Affirmative action and its objections** with **Affirmative action may rest on compensation, anti-subordination, representation or fair opportunity; reverse discrimination is an objection, not a neutral label**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 36

A measure is defended through historical exclusion and representation, while critics call it reverse discrimination. Which debate requires the rationales and objection to be separated?

- A. MacCallum's X-free-from-Y-to-do-Z formula
- B. Rousseau's natural/conventional inequality
- C. Locke's labour title, money and inequality
- D. Affirmative action and its objections

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Affirmative action may rest on compensation, anti-subordination, representation or fair opportunity; reverse discrimination is an objection, not a neutral label** with **Affirmative action and its objections**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 37

One holding supports a person's independence; another gives unaccountable control over others' livelihoods. Which statement identifies the political transformation?

- A. Property can support personal independence but concentrated productive ownership can control others' labour and life-chances.
- B. Berlin's positive pole concerns self-mastery and warns that rulers may coercively claim to represent a person's higher or real self.
- C. MacCallum represents every freedom claim through an agent, a constraint and a purpose without settling which constraints or purposes are justified.
- D. Locke joins labour to enough-and-as-good and spoilage provisos; money bypasses spoilage and enables accumulation whose remaining limit is contested.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Property as security versus social power** with **Property can support personal independence but concentrated productive ownership can control others' labour and life-chances**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 38

A home supports independence, while monopoly ownership determines thousands of workers' livelihoods. Which distinction separates the two political effects?

- A. Taylor's exercise versus opportunity concept
- B. Property as security versus social power
- C. Formal versus substantive equality
- D. Civil-political-economic liberty

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Property can support personal independence but concentrated productive ownership can control others' labour and life-chances.** with **Property as security versus social power.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 39

Labour appropriation initially faces two limits, but monetary accumulation changes the argument. Which statement includes the full sequence and unresolved proviso?

- A. Liberty rejects unreasonable restraint, whereas licence lets one person's action become another's oppression.
- B. Mill places the burden of proof on coercion and permits it presumptively to prevent harm to others, not mere offence or paternal benefit.
- C. Locke joins labour to enough-and-as-good and spoilage provisos; money bypasses spoilage and enables accumulation whose remaining limit is contested.
- D. Taylor argues that an open opportunity is insufficient where internalised or social obstacles prevent meaningful exercise, while Berlin warns against paternalist correction.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Locke's labour title, money and inequality** with **Locke joins labour to enough-and-as-good and spoilage provisos; money bypasses spoilage and enables accumulation whose remaining limit is contested.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 40

An appropriator mixes labour with a resource, faces spoilage and enough-and-as-good limits, then uses money to accumulate. Which account is being tested?

- A. Republican capacity-arbitrariness-impunity test
- B. Alterability plus rational differentiation
- C. Negative liberty/non-interference
- D. Locke's labour title, money and inequality

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Locke joins labour to enough-and-as-good and spoilage provisos; money bypasses spoilage and enables accumulation whose remaining limit is contested.** with **Locke's labour title, money and inequality.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 41

An ideology protects ordinary use while challenging ownership that controls social production. Which statement states the distinction accurately?

- A. Personal holdings support use and security, while private control of major productive assets structures class power.
- B. Roosevelt's January 1941 Four Freedoms address and the August 1941 Atlantic Charter are related but distinct documents.
- C. Domination exists where another has capacity for arbitrary interference with impunity, even when that capacity is not exercised.
- D. Alterability makes inequality a practical reform target but does not by itself prove injustice; need and relevant function still require judgment.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Personal property versus means of production** with **Personal holdings support use and security, while private control of major productive assets structures class power**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 42

A worker's household possessions are protected while private control of factories is challenged. Which distinction explains the different treatment?

- A. Benevolent master and non-arbitrary law
- B. Personal property versus means of production
- C. Affirmative action and its objections
- D. Nozick acquisition-transfer-rectification

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Personal holdings support use and security, while private control of major productive assets structures class power** with **Personal property versus means of production**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 43

Income and control are detached from service or productive function. Which statement supplies the social-democratic test?

- A. Negative liberty asks whether another person or institution obstructs a specified sphere of choice.
- B. Hayek stresses non-coercion and general rules, while Friedman links competitive capitalism to freedom; neither position is identical to Nozick's entitlement theory.
- C. Social-democratic property is judged by service, social origin and common welfare rather than title or dividend alone.
- D. A person under a standing master's power is not free simpliciter; general, reviewable and contestable law can reduce domination.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Hobhouse-Tawney-Laski functionless property** with **Social-democratic property is judged by service, social origin and common welfare rather than title or dividend alone**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 44

An inherited holding yields rent and control without service, while socially useful personal ownership remains protected. Which line of argument applies?

- A. Equal worth versus sameness
- B. Marx-Engels alienation and social production
- C. Berlinian self-mastery and authoritarian risk
- D. Hobhouse-Tawney-Laski functionless property

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Social-democratic property is judged by service, social origin and common welfare rather than title or dividend alone.** with **Hobhouse-Tawney-Laski functionless property.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 45

A current title is voluntary but its origin is unjust. Which statement gives the entitlement theory's internal limit and residual problem?

- A. Nozick's historical entitlement theory requires a proviso and rectification but leaves the correction of unjust history under-specified.
- B. Enabling freedom removes socially alterable barriers such as poverty, insecurity and lack of education without dictating a person's true purpose.
- C. Marcuse analyses false needs and one-dimensional consciousness, while Macpherson contrasts developmental power with extractive power.
- D. Equality affirms equal moral standing without claiming identical talent, need, circumstance or life plan.

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Nozick acquisition-transfer-rectification** with **Nozick's historical entitlement theory requires a proviso and rectification but leaves the correction of unjust history under-specified.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 46

A recent sale was voluntary, but the asset originated in forced dispossession and the remedy is unclear. Which theory requires all three historical inquiries?

- A. Rousseau's natural/conventional inequality
- B. Nozick acquisition-transfer-rectification
- C. Liberty versus licence
- D. Mill's self-/other-regarding boundary

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Nozick's historical entitlement theory requires a proviso and rectification but leaves the correction of unjust history under-specified.** with **Nozick acquisition-transfer-rectification.** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 47

Private productive control estranges workers from their product and activity. Which statement connects the diagnosis to the proposed transformation?

- A. Berlin's positive pole concerns self-mastery and warns that rulers may coercively claim to represent a person's higher or real self.
- B. MacCallum represents every freedom claim through an agent, a constraint and a purpose without settling which constraints or purposes are justified.
- C. Marx and Engels link private control of production to alienation and class domination and seek genuinely social control rather than abolition of personal use.
- D. Rousseau separates physical differences from inequalities of wealth, honour, power and dependence created by convention.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Marx-Engels alienation and social production** with **Marx and Engels link private control of production to alienation and class domination and seek genuinely social control rather than abolition of personal use**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 48

Workers lose control of product, activity and purpose because productive assets are privately controlled. Which account identifies both diagnosis and remedy?

- A. Formal versus substantive equality
- B. Civil-political-economic liberty
- C. Four Freedoms versus Atlantic Charter
- D. Marx-Engels alienation and social production

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Marx and Engels link private control of production to alienation and class domination and seek genuinely social control rather than abolition of personal use**, with **Marx-Engels alienation and social production**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Cross-application ownership note: These are verified Philosophy Optional questions whose primary owners are Social and Political Ideals, Sovereignty, Individual and State, Forms of Government, Political Ideologies, Gender Discrimination. They are not re-routed to Political Theory; they are included because this topic provides a directly usable supporting framework.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Social and Political Ideals.

Solved PYQ 1 - 2018 Q2(a), 20 marks

Question: How far can liberty and equality be considered as distinctive features of democracy ? Discuss.

Model solution

Thesis. Liberty and equality are **DISTINCTIVE** but not **EXHAUSTIVE** features of democracy: they constitute its normative core, yet each is indeterminate until justice and fraternity fix which liberties are basic and which equalities matter. "How far" therefore demands a degree-judgment, not a yes/no.

- **Liberty as a democratic feature.** Democracy institutionalises negative liberties (speech, association, dissent) and a positive, self-ruling liberty -- Rousseau's citizen obeys a law he helps author. Without protected liberty, elections are hollow.
- **Equality as a democratic feature.** Political equality (equal vote, equal eligibility for office) and social equality (absence of status hierarchy) give democracy its non-oligarchic standing. One-person-one-vote is itself an equality of civic worth.
- **Their relation (the mark-bearing move).** At the level of basic liberties the two **REINFORCE** (free speech for all is a liberty **AND** an equality); they conflict only beyond a threshold, where market liberty breeds inequality or aggressive equalising curbs choice. Rawls's lexical priority of equal basic liberties shows liberty need not be traded for aggregate welfare.
- **Qualification / limit.** Liberty and equality alone do not prevent majority tyranny, propaganda or the hollowing of political equality by social hierarchy. Ambedkar's warning is decisive: political democracy is unstable without **SOCIAL** democracy rooted in liberty, equality **AND** fraternity; justice supplies the ordering criterion.

Verdict. Liberty and equality are genuinely distinctive of democracy, but only as far as justice orders them and fraternity sustains them; beyond the threshold they need adjudication, so they are necessary features, not sufficient ones.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it treats "how far" as a degree question, shows the base-level complementarity **AND** the marginal conflict, and closes with the justice/fraternity supplement rather than one-sided praise.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Social and Political Ideals.

Solved PYQ 2 - 2019 Q1(a), 10 marks

Question: How far do you think John Rawls is continuing with Plato's concept of justice?

Model solution

Rawls continues Plato only in treating justice as the ordering virtue of a well-structured society. Plato locates justice in harmony: reason rules the soul, philosopher-rulers govern the city and each functional group performs its proper task. Rawls likewise makes justice the first virtue of the basic structure rather than a private sentiment.

The discontinuity is deeper. Plato derives hierarchy from a metaphysical account of function and the Good. Rawls uses the original position and veil of ignorance to model fair agreement among free and equal citizens. His equal basic liberties, fair equality of opportunity and difference principle reject inherited status and caste-like closure. Thus Rawls inherits Plato's architectonic question -- how should a whole society be ordered justly -- but replaces Plato's hierarchical answer with a democratic and egalitarian procedure.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Social and Political Ideals.

Solved PYQ 3 - 2019 Q4(b), 15 marks

Question: Does liberty put limitations to equality? Discuss.

Model solution

Thesis. Liberty limits equality only at the margin; at the level of basic liberties and equal civic standing the two reinforce each other. This is a "how far" stem, so the mark-bearing move is a conditional verdict.

- **Where liberty limits equality.** Unrestricted freedom of contract, property accumulation and market power let the strong dominate the weak, generating material inequality (Rousseau: convention converts difference into domination). Heavy protection of the private domain can block redistribution.

- **Where it does not.** Equal basic liberties ARE a form of equality; securing them for all is simultaneously a liberty and an equal civic standing. Rawls's priority rules permit inequality only under fair opportunity and benefit to the least advantaged, so liberty is not licence to entrench privilege.

- **The reframing (depth).** On the republican view, material dependence is itself DOMINATION; certain equalising measures therefore INCREASE freedom rather than trading against it -- the un-interfered-with dependent is still unfree. So "liberty vs equality" is not a zero-sum law.

Verdict. Liberty limits equality where market advantage expands unchecked, and supports it where basic liberties and non-domination are secured; the honest answer is a matter of degree, decided by justice.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it gives a genuine degree-judgment, deploys non-domination to dissolve the trade-off, and avoids a flat yes/no.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Social and Political Ideals.

Solved PYQ 4 - 2020 Q1(a), 10 marks

Question: Is the concept of liberty realizable in the modern technological society? Explain.

Model solution

Liberty is realisable in a technological society, but only when technical power is made accountable. Digital networks can enlarge effective freedom through access to knowledge, communication, health services and political participation. In Green's enabling sense, technology can expand people's practical capacity to act.

The same infrastructure can undermine liberty. Surveillance directly restricts a protected sphere; opaque ranking and behavioural nudging shape choices without visible commands; concentrated data creates a standing capacity for arbitrary interference. Formal consent is weak where essential platforms offer no intelligible terms or realistic exit. Liberty therefore requires privacy, explanation, interoperability, independent audit, contestable decisions and protection against retaliation. Technology is not an autonomous fate: ownership and institutional design determine whether it enables agency or produces dependence. Modern liberty is thus possible, but it must combine non-interference, usable capacity and non-domination.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Social and Political Ideals.

Solved PYQ 5 - 2021 Q1(a), 10 marks

Question: Discuss critically the distributive theory of justice as propounded by R. Nozick.

Model solution

Nozick's entitlement theory judges holdings historically, not by a preferred distributional pattern. A distribution is just when assets arise through just acquisition and voluntary transfer; rectification is required where either history is unjust. Individuals possess side-constraints against being used merely as resources for others, so compulsory redistribution is presumptively suspect. The Wilt Chamberlain example shows how free exchanges repeatedly disrupt patterned equality.

The theory powerfully protects agency, consent and personal boundaries. Its weakness is internal as well as external: Nozick gives no complete rule of rectification, while real property histories contain conquest, exclusion and unequal bargaining power. His Lockean proviso also limits acquisition, although its practical threshold is contested. Entitlement theory therefore exposes the coercive costs of patterned redistribution, but cannot legitimise existing holdings without a credible account of background injustice and repair.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Social and Political Ideals.

Solved PYQ 6 - 2021 Q1(b), 10 marks

Question: How does Rousseau distinguish between natural and artificial inequality ? Explain.

Model solution

Rousseau distinguishes natural or physical inequality from moral or political inequality. Natural inequalities arise from age, health, strength and capacities. Artificial inequalities depend on convention: wealth, honour, rank, command and relations of dependence. They are not direct extensions of biology; institutions and social recognition create and stabilise them.

The distinction is critical rather than merely descriptive. In the state of nature, physical differences generate limited dependence because needs are simple. With comparison, division of labour and especially property, conventional advantages accumulate and are presented as legitimate superiority. Rousseau does not claim that every difference must disappear. His target is a social order in which created inequalities allow some persons to dominate others and undermine equal civic standing. The distinction thus helps political theory separate unavoidable diversity from revisable hierarchy.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Social and Political Ideals.

Solved PYQ 7 - 2021 Q2(a), 20 marks

Question: Discuss whether Amartya Sen's idea of justice is an improvement upon Rawl's theory of justice.

Model solution

Thesis. Whether Sen improves on Rawls is CRITERION-RELATIVE: judged by attention to realised freedom and remediable injustice Sen improves on Rawls; judged by the need for determinate institutional principles Rawls retains the advantage. Name the test before applying it.

- **Rawls in brief.** A just basic structure chosen behind the veil of ignorance:

equal basic liberties, fair equality of opportunity and the difference principle. Its focus is ideal, transcendental and institution-centred.

- **Sen's reorientation.** Sen contrasts NITI (correctness of rules and institutions) with NYAYA (justice realised in actual lives). A society may have fine rules yet produce grave injustice, so we should COMPARE feasible social states and remove manifest injustice rather than seek one perfectly just structure; the metric is CAPABILITIES, refined through PUBLIC REASONING.

- **The improvement, assessed.** By the criterion of realised freedom, Sen improves on Rawls -- primary goods ignore the diversity of conversion into real freedom, and transcendental design can neglect how people actually fare. But by the criterion of institutional determinacy, comparative ranking without an ideal benchmark can under-determine choice among rival improvements.

- **Rawlsian reply.** Institutions remain indispensable preconditions of justice; comparison still presupposes standards the ideal theory helps supply.

Verdict. Sen improves on Rawls in ORIENTATION (from arrangements to lives, from resources to capabilities), but does not simply supersede him; "improvement" holds only on a stated criterion, and both are needed.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it states the criterion of improvement first, uses niti/nyaya and capabilities as argument, concedes what Rawls still does better, and gives a criterion-relative verdict.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Social and Political Ideals.

Solved PYQ 8 - 2022 Q1(d), 10 marks

Question: "Complete liberty may lead to inequality while order and restrictions imply a necessary loss of freedom." Critically discuss.

Model solution

The statement captures a real tension but presents it too absolutely. Unregulated liberty can magnify unequal starting power: formally free contracts may produce dependence, concentrated property and diminished options for weaker parties. Conversely, law necessarily restricts some choices through taxation, safety rules and rights enforcement.

However, restriction does not always reduce freedom overall. A republican view distinguishes arbitrary domination from non-arbitrary, contestable law; a Green-style view treats education and social protection as conditions of effective agency. Rules against coercion can secure an equal sphere of liberty, while unchecked private power may destroy it. The proper question is not liberty versus order in the abstract, but who is constrained, for what public reason, under what safeguards and with what effect on others' agency. Legitimate order should prevent domination and enlarge equal freedom rather than impose paternal control.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Social and Political Ideals.

Solved PYQ 9 - 2022 Q2(c), 15 marks

Question: Explain the difference between the notion of equity and equality with reference to Marxian philosophy.

Model solution

Thesis. In Marxian philosophy, EQUALITY is the application of one common measure to all, while EQUITY is differentiated distribution responsive to real need; Marx's deeper claim is that formal equal right can be a right of INEQUALITY.

- **The distinction.** Equality = same standard for everyone (equivalent exchange among legal equals). Equity = shares differentiated by need and actual condition ("to each according to his need"). Equal treatment of unequally-placed people reproduces disadvantage.

- **Marx's argument.** Bourgeois equality abstracts from class structure. The wage contract LOOKS free and equal, but a right measured by a common standard is applied to people who differ in need, burden and family condition -- so equal right is, in content, a right of inequality; and the wage relation itself is structurally exploitative.

- **The two-stage caution.** The need-principle belongs to a HIGHER stage of cooperation where alienated labour and scarcity are transformed; it is not a market-time salary rule, and reading it as one invites the "vague / weakens incentive" objection.

Verdict. Equality and equity diverge because a single measure cannot be fair to unequal needs; Marx uses the distinction to expose the class content hidden beneath formally equal exchange.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it fixes the measure-vs-need distinction, roots it in the equal-right-as-right-of-inequality argument, and flags the higher-stage qualification without drifting into a Political-Ideologies essay.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Social and Political Ideals.

Solved PYQ 10 - 2023 Q1(a), 10 marks

Question: What is meant by justice as fairness? Explain Rawls' theory of justice.

Model solution

Justice as fairness means that the principles governing society's basic structure should be those free and equal persons would accept under fair conditions. Rawls models those conditions through the original position: behind a veil of ignorance, parties know general social facts but not their class, talents, religion or conception of the good. Accidental advantage therefore cannot determine the bargain.

The parties select two principles. Each person receives an equal scheme of basic liberties. Social and economic inequalities are permitted only when offices are open under fair equality of opportunity and inequalities benefit the least advantaged. Equal liberty has priority, and fair opportunity precedes the difference principle. The theory joins procedural impartiality to substantive institutional requirements. Critics question the hypothetical choice and priority rules, but its enduring force is to test whether social arrangements are defensible without knowing one's eventual position.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Social and Political Ideals.

Solved PYQ 11 - 2024 Q1(a), 10 marks

Question: Briefly discuss Plato's concept of justice.

Model solution

Plato's theory has an absolutist tendency because justice is tied to an objective order discovered through knowledge of the Good. Philosopher-rulers define the common good, occupational functions are differentiated and individual claims are subordinate to harmony of the whole. Guardians also regulate education and culture, leaving little room for plural conceptions of a good life or institutional opposition.

Yet "absolutist" should not mean sheer personal arbitrariness. Rule is constrained by rational function, demanding education and an impersonal ideal of justice. Plato also permits limited movement where aptitude disclosed by education fits another function, so class placement is not simply hereditary closure. The deeper problem is epistemic and political: those said to know the Good face weak public accountability. Plato offers a powerful account of ordered competence, but modern liberty requires contestation, equal citizenship and checks on rulers.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Social and Political Ideals.

Solved PYQ 12 - 2024 Q2(b), 15 marks

Question: Critically evaluate the concepts of liberty and equality as political ideals.

Model solution

Thesis. Liberty and equality are the twin political ideals of a free society, but each is powerful only when specified and disciplined; evaluated critically, they are complementary at the base and rivalrous at the margin, and both need justice.

- **Liberty, specified.** Negative liberty (freedom from interference) guards against coercion and paternalism; positive liberty (self-mastery) and the republican third family (non-domination) capture what mere non-interference misses. Objection: negative liberty can serve the already powerful -- true if isolated from fair background conditions.

- **Equality, specified.** Formal, political, social and economic equality, plus the modern question "equality of what?" (welfare, resources, capabilities). Objection: aggressive equalising can flatten choice and desert -- true only if it ignores thresholds, fair opportunity and capability floors.

- **Critical relation.** Equal basic liberties ARE an equality; conflict appears only beyond a threshold. Non-domination shows some equalisation INCREASES freedom (material dependence is domination). Rawls's priority rules keep liberty from being traded away while permitting justified inequality.

Verdict. As political ideals, liberty and equality are indispensable but INDETERMINATE alone -- each is silent about which liberties and which equalities matter; justice supplies the ordering criterion, so they are best defended together.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it specifies both ideals (three liberties, four equalities + the metric question), runs objection-reply on each, and closes with the ordering role of justice.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Social and Political Ideals.

Solved PYQ 13 - 2025 Q1(e), 10 marks

Question: Discuss the salient features of equality according to J.S. Mill.

Model solution

Mill's equality is developmental rather than a demand for identical outcomes. Equal moral standing requires the removal of inherited legal disabilities and oppressive customs, most clearly in his defence of women's equality. Speech, association and experiments in living must be protected for all, because individuality cannot develop where dominant groups monopolise opinion or status.

Mill also supports education and reforms that reduce avoidable dependence and concentrated inherited advantage. Yet he permits differences arising from diverse capacities, effort and voluntary choice; equality does not erase individuality. A tension remains because some transitional proposals, such as plural voting for the educated, qualify immediate political equality. The durable core of Mill's view is therefore equal citizenship and equal opportunity for self-development, combined with liberty for diverse life plans rather than a strict equality of final condition.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Social and Political Ideals.

Solved PYQ 14 - 2025 Q4(a), 20 marks

Question: How are both equality and liberty inadequate as social and political ideals without justice? Discuss.

Model solution

Thesis. Equality and liberty are indispensable but INADEQUATE by themselves, because each is indeterminate about its own content; justice is the architectonic ideal that supplies the ordering criteria and decides their scope and priority.

- **Why liberty alone is inadequate.** "Liberty" does not tell us WHICH liberties are basic, or how to weigh one person's freedom against another's. A tyrant and a citizen both invoke freedom; negative, positive and republican conceptions pull apart. Only a theory of justice ranks basic liberties and protects them (Rawls's lexical priority).
- **Why equality alone is inadequate.** "Equality" is under-specified -- of status, rights, opportunity, welfare, resources, capability or outcome? Each metric yields different institutions, and without a criterion, equality collapses into either mechanical levelling or empty formalism.
- **What justice supplies.** Justice provides the adjudicatory criteria -- desert, fairness, entitlement, need, capability, rectification and public reason -- that say which inequalities are justified and which liberties are basic. Compare the positions: liberty-first (Nozick) protects self-ownership but lets background injustice hollow real freedom; equality-first levelling flags oppression but flattens choice and desert; justice-as-ordering balances them by principle.
- **Indian anchor.** Ambedkar: political democracy (equal votes, formal liberty) is unstable without SOCIAL democracy -- liberty, equality AND fraternity -- so justice must reach lived social standing, not only procedure.

Verdict. Liberty and equality are the substance of a just society, but justice is its FORM: it is the ideal that disciplines and coordinates the other two, and without it each remains normatively incomplete.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it proves inadequacy by showing each ideal is indeterminate about its own content, compares three ordering positions, anchors in Ambedkar, and ends with the architectonic verdict.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Sovereignty.

Solved PYQ 15 - 2022 Q2(a), 20 marks

Question: What arguments does Bodin present to contend that sovereignty must be absolute, perpetual and undivided? Is Bodin's conception of sovereignty compatible with the social and political ideals of equality, justice and liberty? Critically discuss.

Model solution

Thesis. Bodin argues sovereignty must be *absolute, perpetual and undivided* to end civil war; but measured against equality, justice and liberty his conception is only partly compatible -- historically foundational, normatively problematic.

PART A - the arguments.

- **Absolute.** To end faction the sovereign must have no human superior within the commonwealth and be able to make and unmake law without consent -- yet he is still bound by divine law, natural law and the *leges imperii*.
- **Perpetual.** Sovereignty attaches to the *office*, not a temporary magistrate, so authority persists across rulers and cannot be reclaimed by those who conferred it.
- **Undivided.** If two authorities were each final, their conflict could reopen the disorder Bodin means to close; hence one final law-making centre.

PART B - compatibility with the ideals.

- **Tension conceded.** Concentrated final authority offers weak guarantees against the abuse that equality, justice and liberty are designed to check; the higher-law limits are conceptually real but institutionally soft.
- **Partial defence.** Bodin's order-first logic secures the civil peace without which no ideal is realisable, and his higher-law limits deny pure caprice.

Verdict. Bodin is the indispensable founder of the modern doctrine, but his absolutism is compatible with the ideals only where those limits genuinely bind; modern equality, justice and liberty require the institutional checks -- constitutional supremacy, rights, judicial review -- that Bodin's scheme lacks.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks - it runs each attribute with its argument (Part A), then grades compatibility honestly (Part B), conceding the absolute-vs-bound tension instead of defending or dismissing Bodin wholesale.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Individual and State.

Solved PYQ 16 - 2024 Q3(a), 20 marks

Question: Do you agree with the view that Aristotle was more successful than Plato in steering a middle course between 'Statism' and 'individualism'? Discuss with arguments.

Model solution

Directive: Do you agree with a *comparative* claim ("more successful than") -> compare, do not merely describe.

Thesis. Broadly agree. On the **statism <-> individualism** axis, Aristotle's polis steers nearer a defensible middle than Plato's individual-subordinating ideal state -- though both remain perfectionist by modern liberal lights, so the success is *comparative*, not absolute.

Plato (the statist/organic pole). The *Republic* subordinates the individual to the ideal state: justice is each class performing its function; the guardians hold no private family or property; the individual's good is realised only through the whole. This tilts toward **Statism**/organicism.

Aristotle (the middle). Man is *zoon politikon* -- fulfilled only in the polis, which is "prior in nature" -- yet the household retains **private property** and a private sphere, and virtue is the **mean** between extremes. The polis is an *association for the good life*, not a super-organism; individuality survives *within* it.

Objection 1. Aristotle also excludes slaves, women and non-citizens, so his "middle" is narrow. **Reply.** Relative to Plato's abolition of the private sphere for the guardians, Aristotle still preserves an individual/household domain -- the comparison, not an absolute standard, is what the stem asks.

Objection 2 (liberal). Neither is a modern individualist; both subordinate the person to a substantive common good. **Reply.** Precisely -- but "more successful" is comparative, and Aristotle's mean is the better balance.

India-centric tie. The mature verdict -- neither atom outside society nor cell inside the state -- echoes Aristotle's balance; the Indian order pairs rights with duties and directive welfare, a graded middle.

Graded verdict. Agree, comparatively: Aristotle steers the better middle course, with the caveat that both fall short of modern rights-based individualism.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks - it stages the statism/individualism axis accurately, *compares* Plato and Aristotle rather than describing each, answers the comparative modal "more successful," and voices two objections with replies.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Forms of Government.

Solved PYQ 17 - 2021 Q1(d), 10 marks

Question: Does monarchy as a form of government leave room for individual freedom? Explain.

Model solution

Subjects in a monarchy may enjoy zones of non-interference, but that alone does not establish political freedom. A benevolent monarch can leave daily choices untouched while retaining unchecked capacity to intervene. Republican liberty therefore asks whether power is arbitrary, whether decisions require public reasons and whether subjects can contest them without fear.

A constitutional monarchy can meet these conditions when elected institutions govern, rights are judicially protected and the monarch lacks discretionary political command. An absolute monarchy cannot secure equal civic status because subjects remain dependent on the ruler's will, even if interference is infrequent. Berlinian negative liberty captures the importance of actual obstruction, but non-domination adds security of status and control over public power. Thus monarchy is compatible with freedom only where the monarch is legally constrained and people are citizens rather than dependants.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Political Ideologies.

Solved PYQ 18 - 2018 Q3(b), 15 marks

Question: Are Marxian Socialism and individual freedom consistent ? Discuss critically.

Model solution

Thesis. Marxian socialism and individual freedom are consistent ONLY CONDITIONALLY: they are consistent where collective ownership genuinely ENLARGES each person's real self-development and democratic control, and they become inconsistent -- the emancipatory claim defeating itself -- where "collective" power hardens into bureaucratic command.

- **Reframe "freedom".** Marx rejects a purely negative liberty (non-interference)

that leaves formal rights operating over radically unequal social conditions. His positive ideal is non-domination PLUS self-development: the capacity to engage in conscious, social, creative activity, of which alienated labour deprives the worker (evidence P3 -- estrangement from product, activity, species-being and others).

- **The consistency argument.** If the means of production are brought under

genuinely social, democratic control, then the structural coercion of the wage-relation is removed and freedom is EXTENDED to those the market subordinated -- collective ownership is the condition, not the enemy, of real freedom.

- **The self-defeat condition (objection -> reply -> residual).** Objection

(bureaucratic domination): state ownership can become ownership by officials, and a transitional "dictatorship of the proletariat" can entrench rather than wither (the strongest historical objection at §2.9). Reply (M. N. Roy's radical humanism): retain Marx's critique of exploitation but reject economic determinism and party absolutism and restore individual reason and ethical autonomy, since concentrated power cannot reliably serve emancipation. Residual: the historical record of transitional states remains adverse, so accountability, plural organisation and civil liberty must be built INTO the transition, not postponed.

Verdict (conditional). Marxian socialism and individual freedom are consistent as an IDEAL of collective self-development, and inconsistent in any form that subordinates the individual to class, party or historical necessity; the doctrine survives only if it constitutionalises the freedom it promises.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks -- it turns "consistent?" into the "only if... otherwise self-defeats" conditional (P3 + §2.8), brings M. N. Roy as the internal Indian reply, concedes the adverse record, and grades rather than answers yes/no.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Political Ideologies.

Solved PYQ 19 - 2024 Q1(d), 10 marks

Question: Present an exposition of the concept of alienation as propounded by Marx.

Model solution

Marx describes alienation as a condition in which labour confronts the worker as an external and dominating power. Under capitalist private ownership, workers are alienated from the product they create, from the activity of production, from their species-being or capacity for conscious creative work, and from other persons. Wage labour becomes a means of survival rather than self-directed human development.

Alienation is therefore not merely a feeling of dissatisfaction. It is rooted in social relations that separate producers from control over the means, purposes and results of production. Competition and commodity exchange make human powers appear as powers of things and markets. Marx's remedy is not simply higher wages but transformation of productive relations so associated producers exercise social control. Critics question whether all specialisation is alienating, but the concept remains a powerful account of unfreedom within formally voluntary labour.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Political Ideologies.

Solved PYQ 20 - 2024 Q1(e), 10 marks

Question: Compare socialism and communism as two distinct political ideologies.

Model solution

Socialism and communism are related by their criticism of class domination and private control of major productive resources, but they are not identical traditions. Socialism broadly seeks social ownership, cooperation and reduced inequality; it includes democratic, market and revolutionary variants. In Marxist usage, communism names a classless association in which productive abundance and social control make coercive class rule unnecessary.

Marx also distinguishes a lower phase, where distribution still bears marks of the old society, from a higher phase guided by "from each according to ability, to each according to need." Democratic socialists may retain markets, constitutional pluralism and a substantial state, whereas communists may treat socialism as a transitional order. The relation is therefore genealogical and conceptual rather than one of simple equivalence: communism is one radical destination within the wider socialist family.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Gender Discrimination.

PYQ 21 - 2023 · 1(c) (10 marks)

Question: Do you agree that the rights concerning land and property have empowered women? Discuss.

Model solution

Property rights can strengthen women's agency by providing income security, collateral, bargaining power within households and an exit option from abusive dependence. Equal inheritance and ownership also recognise women as independent legal persons rather than dependants mediated through male relatives. In agrarian settings, secure land rights can improve access to credit, public schemes and productive decisions.

Formal title alone, however, is insufficient. Women may face coercive waivers, weak records, costly litigation, customary exclusion and limited control over the proceeds of property. Empowerment therefore requires clear inheritance rules, joint or individual titles where appropriate, accessible registration, legal aid and effective possession. Property is neither the sole measure of freedom nor an unlimited right over others; its value lies in converting equal status into usable capability. Well-designed rights reduce domination while remaining subject to legitimate social obligations.

Primary owner: Philosophy Paper II - Gender Discrimination.

PYQ 22 - 2025 · 1(b) (10 marks)

Question: How does gender as a social construct affect individuals' opportunities, rights, and access to resources? Critically discuss.

Model solution

Gender is socially constructed insofar as institutions attach roles, expectations and hierarchies to perceived sex differences. Family practices, education, religion, media and labour markets teach what counts as masculine or feminine and reward conformity. Variation across cultures and history shows that many gendered divisions are neither fixed nor biologically inevitable.

Construction does not mean that bodies are unreal or that individuals can simply choose away social constraint. Material embodiment, reproduction and violence interact with norms, while class, caste and race shape gender differently. The concept is useful because it reveals how apparently natural roles distribute property, care work, authority and political voice. Since these arrangements are institutionally produced, they can also be challenged through equal rights, transformed socialisation and redistribution of care. Gender is thus a durable social structure, not an immutable destiny.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original Mains Practice 1 - 10 marks

Question: Explain why Mill's distinction between self-regarding and other-regarding conduct does not make every socially consequential act coercible. Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Mill's harm principle creates a presumption of liberty for competent adults: coercion against their will is justified presumptively to prevent harm to others, not merely because conduct is disliked, offensive or imprudent.

Core analysis: The self-regarding and other-regarding distinction identifies the primary direction of an act's effects, but social consequence is broader than harm. Expression, consumption and unconventional living may influence others, alter norms or impose discomfort without violating a protected interest. If every indirect effect counted as harm, the principle would license majority morality and destroy the experimental individuality Mill values. Regulation therefore requires a specified victim, sufficiently serious setback, causal connection and proportionate response. Mill's later arguments for education, taxation and inheritance reform are separate social arguments, not automatic deductions from the harm principle.

Critical evaluation: The boundary is difficult because dependency and cumulative risk blur private and public effects. That difficulty shifts the burden to justification; it does not erase the presumption for liberty.

Conclusion: Mill's principle is therefore a strong presumption for individuality under a harm-based burden of proof, not a mechanical rule that converts every social effect into legitimate coercion.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

Original Mains Practice 2 - 10 marks

Question: Distinguish formal equality, substantive equality, equality of opportunity and equality of outcome. Can differential treatment serve equality? Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Equality contains several standards that answer different questions. Formal equality removes explicit legal privilege, while substantive equality asks whether equal status can actually be used under unequal social conditions.

Core analysis: Equality of opportunity concerns genuinely fair access to offices and advantages, not merely an open rulebook. Equality of outcome examines whether final distributions leave avoidable deprivation or domination intact; it need not demand identical shares and may instead defend thresholds or a social minimum. Differential treatment can serve equality where identical rules reproduce a demonstrated disadvantage. Affirmative action may be defended through compensation, anti-subordination, representation or fair opportunity, while 'reverse discrimination' names an objection rather than a neutral description.

Critical evaluation: Difference alone never proves justification. A legitimate measure must identify the barrier, connect the classification to its removal, protect individual standing and remain proportionate, contestable and open to revision.

Conclusion: Differential treatment serves equality only when it removes a specified barrier to equal standing or fair opportunity, remains proportionate and reviewable, and does not become an unexamined substitute for structural reform.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

Original Mains Practice 3 - 15 marks

Question: Compare Berlin's two concepts, Green's positive freedom and republican non-domination. Does MacCallum dissolve their differences? Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Berlin distinguishes negative liberty as non-interference from positive liberty as self-mastery, while warning that a ruler may coercively claim to embody a person's higher self. Green uses a different positive language: freedom requires social conditions for moral development and meaningful action.

Core analysis: Republican non-domination shifts the question from actual interference or capacity to the status of dependence under arbitrary power. The benevolent-master case shows why a person may face little current interference yet remain unfree through the master's standing capacity and impunity. MacCallum's formula - X is free from Y to do or become Z - places all freedom claims in one triadic grammar and exposes false verbal dichotomies. It does not decide whether poverty, internalised desire, credible threat or arbitrary dependence belongs in Y, nor which purposes belong in Z.

Critical evaluation: MacCallum therefore unifies form without dissolving substance. Berlin, Green and republicanism retain different diagnoses and different risks: neglect of capacity, paternalism and institutional overbreadth.

Conclusion: MacCallum reveals a shared grammatical structure, but Berlin, Green and republicanism remain substantively distinct because they identify different constraints, purposes and institutional dangers.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

Original Mains Practice 4 - 15 marks

Question: Compare Locke, Hegel and Marx on the moral significance of property. Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Locke, Hegel and Marx treat property as morally significant through labour, personhood and social production respectively. Their disagreement concerns both the source and the limits of ownership.

Core analysis: Locke grounds initial appropriation in labour under enough-and-as-good and spoilage provisos; money bypasses spoilage and enables accumulation, while survival of the first proviso remains contested. Hegel treats an external property sphere as the first embodiment of free will within Abstract Right, explaining why secure control matters for personality without proving an unlimited title to accumulation. Marx shifts from individual title to productive relations: personal use is not the main target, whereas private control of the means of production separates workers from product, activity and social power. Property then becomes alienation and class domination.

Critical evaluation: Labour can justify an initial claim, personhood a protected sphere, and social production a structural critique. No one argument by itself validates every inherited, concentrated or productive holding.

Conclusion: Property is defensible neither as an absolute natural title nor as an undifferentiated evil: its justification depends on acquisition, personhood, social function and whether ownership enables autonomy or domination.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

Original Mains Practice 5 - 20 marks

Question: The apparent conflict between liberty and equality is mediated by the distribution of property and social power. Evaluate through Rawls, Dworkin and Nozick. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Liberty and equality appear opposed when property is treated as a pre-political domain immune from scrutiny. Once ownership is recognised as a distribution of resources and power, the dispute becomes one about background institutions, responsibility and history.

Core analysis: Rawls gives equal basic liberties lexical priority but requires fair equality of opportunity and permits inequality only where it benefits the least advantaged. Dworkin's equality of resources uses hypothetical auction and insurance to neutralise brute luck while retaining responsibility for option luck. Nozick rejects patterned end-state rules and asks whether holdings arose through just acquisition and transfer under a modified Lockean proviso, with rectification for injustice. These standards expose different defects: structurally unfair starting points, unequal resource endowments and coercive or unjust historical title. The NAKSHA inquiry anchor illustrates why documented title, accessible procedure and contestability are distinct from redistribution.

Further development: The comparison also changes the unit of evaluation. Rawls examines the basic structure, Dworkin the resource position of responsible agents, and Nozick the historical chain of holdings. A conclusion must therefore state whether institutions, endowments or transactions are being judged before calling an inequality unjust.

Critical evaluation: The theories cannot be fused. A defensible judgment protects basic agency and title while testing whether property institutions reproduce avoidable dependence and whether rectification is sufficiently specified.

Conclusion: The liberty-equality conflict is best treated as a dispute over fair background institutions, resources and historical entitlement, with property justified only where its distribution survives all three forms of scrutiny.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.

Original Mains Practice 6 - 20 marks

Question: Can affirmative action and redistribution enhance equal liberty without becoming paternalistic or arbitrary? Discuss using Mill, Berlin, Green, Rawls and Nozick. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Affirmative action and redistribution can enlarge liberty where deprivation and inherited exclusion make formally equal choice unusable. Their legitimacy nevertheless depends on preserving agency and constraining public discretion.

Core analysis: Mill's harm principle resists coercion based merely on a person's own good, but his broader egalitarian and social reforms show that liberty need not mean laissez-faire. Green treats education, security and material capability as conditions of effective freedom. Rawls protects equal basic liberties while requiring fair opportunity and benefit to the least advantaged. Berlin supplies the warning: officials must not claim authority to impose citizens' true purposes. Nozick adds historical-title and rectification tests and rejects patterned seizure of just holdings. Affirmative action should therefore be justified through specified compensatory, anti-subordination, representational or opportunity mechanisms rather than the label of benevolent policy.

Further development: Republican non-domination adds a further institutional test: a corrective measure should reduce arbitrary dependence rather than replace private domination with unreviewable official discretion. Effective notice, reason-giving, accessible appeal and periodic evaluation connect Green's enabling purpose to Berlin's and Nozick's limits on coercive power.

Critical evaluation: Correction becomes arbitrary when classifications lack evidence, remedies are disproportionate or affected people cannot contest them. It enhances equal liberty when rules are transparent, reviewable, time-sensitive and directed at demonstrable barriers.

Conclusion: Group-sensitive correction can enlarge equal liberty when it removes demonstrable barriers under transparent, proportionate and contestable rules, while preserving agency, basic liberties and historical-title scrutiny.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.